# Roaster



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Roaster / Dryer

## What it is used for

A roaster or dryer uses controlled heat and airflow to roast or remove moisture from suitable food materials. Correct settings help achieve consistent processing while reducing scorching, contamination and fire risks.

## Main parts

- Identify the loading hopper, tray or rotating drum, depending on design.
- Locate the heating element, burner or heat source.
- Identify the airflow fan, vents and exhaust arrangement, where fitted.
- Locate the temperature control and temperature indicator.
- Identify the timer, speed control and operating panel, if provided.
- Locate the product discharge opening and collection container.
- Identify guards, insulation, emergency stop and cleaning access points.

## Before you start

1. Read the operating instructions and obtain supervised training before use.
2. Confirm that the machine is suitable for the intended food material.
3. Inspect heating elements, burners, wiring, guards and ventilation passages for damage.
4. Clean food-contact surfaces and prepare clean, heat-resistant collection containers.
5. Check that exhaust outlets and airflow passages are unobstructed.
6. Select the appropriate temperature, time and loading quantity for the product.
7. Wear suitable protective clothing and heat-resistant gloves where required.

## How to use

1. Place the machine on a stable, heat-resistant surface with sufficient clearance.
2. Load the prepared food material without exceeding the recommended capacity.
3. Close the chamber or drum and secure all required guards.
4. Select the prescribed temperature, time and airflow settings.
5. Start the heating system according to the operating instructions.
6. Allow the machine to reach the specified operating temperature before processing if required.
7. Monitor the product colour, moisture removal and processing progress through safe observation points.
8. Adjust settings only within the approved operating procedure.
9. Stop heating if smoke, burning smell or abnormal temperature occurs.
10. Switch off the machine and allow hot components to cool before unloading.

1. Transfer the finished product into a clean, suitable container.

## ⚠ Safety

- Keep hands away from hot chambers, trays, drums and exhaust outlets.
- Never block ventilation or operate the machine with damaged guards.
- Keep combustible materials away from burners and hot surfaces.
- Disconnect electrical power before cleaning or servicing internal components.
- Use fuel-fired equipment only with appropriate ventilation and safe fuel connections.
- Do not spray water onto hot electrical components or burning oil.

## Care & storage

- Switch off and cool the machine before cleaning food-contact surfaces.
- Remove crumbs, residue and accumulated grease using approved methods.
- Inspect heaters, burners, fans, seals and electrical connections regularly.
- Store the clean machine in a dry area protected from dust and pests.

## Common mistakes to avoid

- Loading too much material and preventing uniform heating or drying.
- Using excessive heat that burns or discolours the product.
- Ignoring blocked airflow or ventilation passages.
- Cleaning the machine while surfaces remain hot or power is connected.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*